

Micah Farfour

Satellite Imagery Analyst

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Selected Works

Amnesty International
(2022) [Ukraine: "He's not coming back". War crimes in Northwest areas of Kyiv Oblast](#)

Reichalt, S. (2022) [Planet's Data Helps Amnesty International Tackle Deforestation in Cambodia.](#)

Farfour, M. (2021) [Using VIIRS Fire Data for Human Rights Research](#)

Amnesty International
(2021) [Flashpoints in the Amazon](#)

Education

Spatial Thoughts
**Google Earth Engine,
Python Foundation for
Spatial Analysis**

Galvanize courses
**Intro to JavaScript, Intro
to Python**

University of Colorado
**Master of Engineering
GIS, B.A. Environmental
Science**

Professional Experience

Special Advisor, Remote Sensing, Amnesty International, London, 2016 – Present

Lead, produce and provide guidance on remote sensing and geospatial analysis for Amnesty International with the multidisciplinary Evidence Lab team to document human rights abuses across the globe.

- Listen to research problems and develop methodology to find accurate and relevant remote sensing analytical findings.
- Order, process and analyze all types of multispectral and radar imagery using ENVI, ArcGIS, QGIS, GEE and other tools for research in human rights abuses including developing LULCs, conducting change detection analyses and providing photointerpretation based on ten years of experience.
- Facilitate communication and relationships with satellite imagery companies, geospatial research institutes, contractors and technology volunteers.
- Collaborate with researchers to geolocate events using multiple information sources, including VIIRS fire data, satellite imagery and social media to corroborate witness testimony in human rights abuses.
- Train internal and external partners in the use of open source geospatial information and tools to gather and share data.
- Develop maps and pre-field analytical reports for research projects.
- Monitor and document changes in areas of human rights interest, such as the Darfur region, and share with relevant researchers.
- Research and test innovation in geospatial technology, including machine learning and artificial intelligence, to develop paths to incorporate new tools or data in documenting events.
- Design and develop high quality analytical reports, image chips and other cartographic visualizations for press releases and reports using ArcGIS, InDesign, Shorthand, Datawrapper and other tools.
- Support other Evidence Lab colleagues in projects such as providing expertise in large crowdsourcing data projects, verifying photo and video geolocation of events, editing documents for blog posts or other public outputs among other support.
- Write pieces for team site, Citizen Evidence Lab, to share knowledge and experiences with innovation in investigating human rights abuses with the public.
- Attend conferences and trainings to learn new innovations in remote sensing for possible application to human rights research.
- Present projects and case studies at conferences and university events.

All-Source Analyst, DigitalGlobe, Colorado, 2012 – 2015

Diligently researched human rights violations to proactively task satellites and analyze imagery, ensuring visual compelling analytic reports for customers and internal teams.

- Ordered, processed and analyzed true-color and near-infrared imagery using ERDAS IMAGINE and ArcGIS for customer products and pilot projects including Satellite Sentinel Project (SSP).
- Supported crowdsourcing team through imagery acquisition, answering crowd questions, providing object identification tips and quality checking campaign results on major disaster events and large humanitarian crises.

Other Skills

Software/tools: ArcGIS, ERDAS IMAGINE, QGIS, ENVI, Google Earth Engine, GE Pro, Shorthand, Datawrapper, Sentinel Hub, Planet Explorer, InDesign, Microsoft Office/Access
Languages: Fluent Chinyanja, Basic Spanish, Italian, Russian

- Independently managed and grew customer contracts through excellent customer service, same day feasibility assessments, timely development of relevant geospatial analytic reports and project budget tracking.
- Researched open source information and remote sensing data sources to activate satellite monitoring of disaster events for dissemination to customers and media through geospatial platform.
- Designed, edited and published over 60 in-depth imagery articles and reports.

Long-Term Community Recovery Team Lead, FEMA, Washington, DC, 2011 – 2012

Managed team of specialists in the formation and production of a long-term community recovery plan for disaster stricken communities.

- Streamlined project communications between local, regional and national counterparts to ensure all resources were utilized while organizing and facilitating community-led meetings to brainstorm, prioritize and develop plans for recovery projects.

Client Schedule Coordinator, Veterans Green Jobs, Colorado, 2010

Developed standard operating procedures for new scheduling software to streamline flow of information for improving communication between organization and clients.

- Met goal of tripling production by training counterparts in new software procedures to increase efficiency and organization across the company.

Lead Forestry Technician, United States Forest Service, Washington, 2009

Supervised four-person construction crew for continual improvement of over 200-miles of trails while ensuring policies and procedures were upheld.

- Identified land and structural problems in the field and researched cost-effective solutions leading to the design and construction of five bridges and multiple trail reconstruction projects on four major tourist trails.

Agriculture Extension Agent, United States Peace Corps, Zambia, Africa, 2006 – 2008

Developed programs with local stakeholders, government counterparts, and international organizations to sustainably increase food security in a 100-kilometer catchment area of Zambia.

- Collaborated with USAID funded organizations to produce M&E report of nutrition programs in 40 schools.
- Fluently learned the local language, Chinyanja, and communicated all trainings in the language to reach more local stakeholders.